

```

• <?php
• $arr = [1.5, "4", "10.83", 2];
• sort($arr);
• foreach($arr as $x){
• echo $x . ', ';
• }
• ?>

```

The output of the above program is:

```

• 1.5, 2, 4, 10.83,

```

This program creates an array with 4 elements, which can all be read as numbers (floats and integers) but 2 of them are represented as strings (yes, an array can contain different data types in PHP allowing flexibility) and PHP converts them all to numerical form and then does the sort. Also, a 'foreach' construct shows that you can handle the elements of an array pretty easily. If you were to introduce a string in that array which cannot be converted to a number, PHP will treat all elements as strings and sorting will happen considering all elements as strings but it would not fail. You can alter the strictness of PHP's behavior in many cases by adding additional checks.

We have barely touched the surface of PHP. If it looks interesting, and you would like to learn more, go on reading.

Tools and resources

While PHP requires you to have a web server on machine, we cannot discuss its installation in detail. Depending on your OS, you can best install PHP as follows:

1. Windows: Install XAMPP – this is the best way to start off on Windows.
2. Mac OS X: PHP and Apache come bundled with OS X. We cannot detail the process here due to space constraints. You can read the official PHP guide for the same here: <http://php.net/manual/en/install.macosx.bundled.php>.
3. Linux: You can install PHP easily using your package manager. Most Linux DVDs also carry PHP with them. On Ubuntu, it is as easy as:


```

sudo apt-get install apache2 php5 libapache2-mod-php5
php5-mcrypt

```

Once installed, you can start writing code in no time. Any simple text editor will do the job. But in time you would need to get faster. Eclipse with